Unit 8



RESTRAINTS

RESTRAINT:

Restraint is defined as 'the intentional restriction of a person's voluntary movement or behavior.

Restraints are physical, chemical or environmental measures used to control the physical or behavioral activity of a person or a portion of his/her body.



General Principles for Use of Restraints

- Should be selected to reduce clients movement only as much as necessary
- Nurse should carefully explain type of restraint and reason for its use
- Should not interfere with treatment
- Bony prominences should be padded before applying it
- Should be changed when they become soiled or damp
- Should be secured away from a clients reach
- Should be able to quickly release the device
- Should be attached to bed frame not to side rails
- Should be removed a minimum of every 2 hrs
- Frequent circulations checks should be performed when extremity is used



Indications:

- Displaying behavior that is putting themselves at risk of harm
- Requiring treatment by a legal order, for example, under the Mental Health Act 2007
- Requiring urgent life-saving treatment
- Needs to be maintained in secure settings
- All alternatives must be tried before restraining
- Offer bedpan or bathroom every 2 hours
- Offer fluids and nourishment frequently, keep water within reach
- Provide directional activity
- Decrease stimuli and noise
- Provide change of position, up to chair, ambulation

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